



HENRY PURCELL, c. 1695

This portrait of Henry Purcell was painted by John Closterman in the year of the great composer's tragically early death in 1695. He was just 36 and at the peak of his career. The illness that caused his death is unknown, although there is speculation that it was tuberculosis. There is also speculation that he died from a chill, which he caught when he came home drunk one night and his wife locked him out of the house.